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South MS teens launch fundraiser to fight lawsuits related to Nolan Wells' death

By **Margaret Baker**

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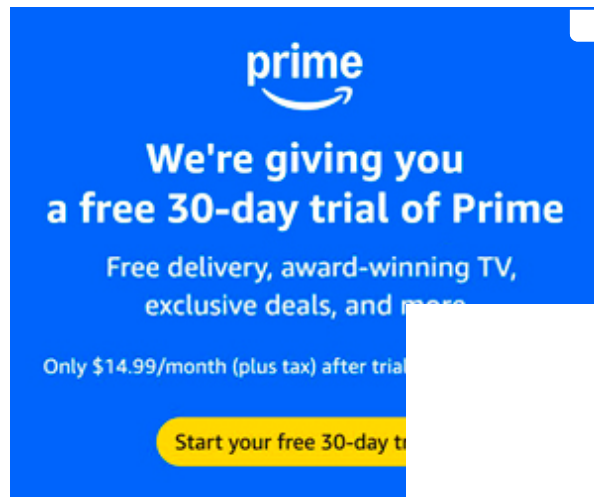


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A fundraising campaign was launched on [GiveSendGo](#) on Saturday to help cover legal fees for two teens in any pending wrongful death lawsuits filed over the death of Nolan Xavier Wells.

The money is also to cover legal fees in defamation lawsuits for the two teens, Warren Hudson and Jax Pitalo, who were with Wells the day he disappeared.



Since then, another teen, Morgan Seymour, who celebrated with Wells that day and appeared in a now widely circulated photo with him on a boat, has also been added as a beneficiary of the fundraising account.

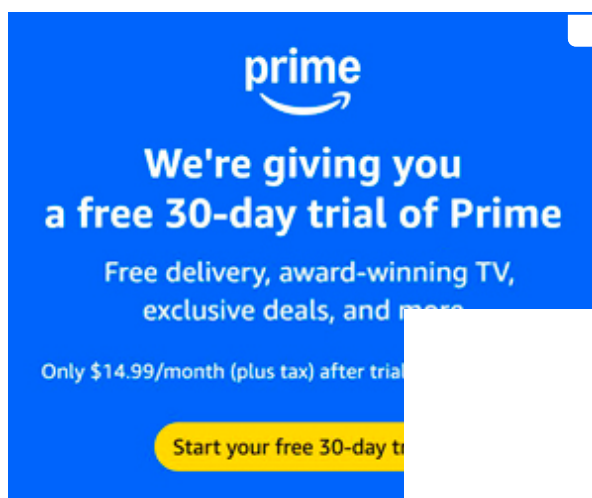


Nolan Wells is pictured here on with three friends, including Morgan Seymour, far left *Provided*

“This fund is created for the sole purpose of fighting these individuals,” Dr.

[Opt-Out Signal Honored](#) said on behalf of his son Saturday.

“Our first goal is to raise money to defend these friends against incoming wrongful death actions filed by Attorney Ben Crump and his team,” Hudson said.



The second goal for the teen in setting up the fundraising account is to “fund a robust legal team to sue for the litany of slander and libels spread by not only (civil rights attorney Ben) Crump but also many social media influencers, news outlets, and local provocateurs.”

In addition, Benjamin Hudson, said the money the teens raise will be used, if litigation is necessary, to “preserve evidence, and hold accountable those who cross the line from expressing opinions into conduct the law may recognize as actionable in any jurisdiction we can find them”

Hudson’s father said the fundraiser the teens set up “is not about silencing legitimate discussion or respectful disagreement.”

Instead, he said, “People are free to ask questions and express opinions.”

“This is about drawing a line against defamation, targeted harassment, threats of violence, doxing, intimidation, and coordinated campaigns that destroy lives before the facts are known.”



Warren Hudson, left, and Jax Pitalo Submitted

Hudson and Pitalo are among a large group of friends who celebrated Independence Day with Wells are a group of other friends.

The friends traveled back to the mainland, about 10 miles from the Mississippi Coast, without Wells, but had his cellphone, prompting speculation about what happened to Wells. The friends also had the cellphones of other friends who had already left the island to make the trip back.

The families accuse Crump of pushing a narrative that falsely portrayed friends

[Opt-Out Signal Honored](#) criminal wrongdoing and a cover-up in connection with

Wells' death.

They allege that Crump's public narrative falsely implicates innocent teenagers in a murder and cover-up, pushing an unproven and damaging agenda online while financially exploiting the tragedy.



Attorney Ben Crump delivers a eulogy during a funeral service for Nolan Wells at Center Pointe Church in Ocean Springs on Monday, July 20, 2026. Jackson Ranger jranger@sunherald.com

After Wells' death, his parents, Elmore and Christine Wonsley, retained Crump to conduct an independent investigation into the circumstances surrounding their son's death.

“They said a lot of inflammatory things,” Hudson said, accusing Crump of being the alleged “ringleader of this internet lynch mob” against the boys who went to Horn Island with Wells.



Nolan Wells *Provided*

Crump has maintained that his focus remains strictly on demanding transparency and pursuing the truth about what happened to Wells.

Wells disappeared during a July 4 trip to Horn Island with a group of friends. Two days later, a National Park Service ranger found his body near the island's northwest tip.

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Margaret is an investigative reporter whose search for truth exposed corrupt sheriffs, a police chief and various jailers and led to the first prosecution of a federal hate crime for the murder of a transgendered person. She worked on the Sun Herald's Pulitzer Prize-winning Hurricane Katrina team. When she pursues a big story, she is relentless.

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